LOG USE 2.0 — User Guide

Personal Cybersecurity Monitor for Windows 10 / 11

1. What LOG USE does

LOG USE is a **visible** security monitor for a Windows PC that you own or administer. It shows you who signed in to Windows, which websites were opened in your browsers, and whether any of them (or any live network connection) match known threats.

Feature	What it does	Where you see it
Windows authentication events	Reads the exact events written by Windows itself: successful sign-in (4624), failed sign-in (4625), sign-out (4634 / 4647), PC locked (4800) and unlocked (4801), with user name, sign-in type (keyboard, Remote Desktop, network), source IP and failure reason.	*Windows sign-ins* tab
Camera prompt at Windows sign-in	When you sign in to Windows, LOG USE starts, shows a "Windows sign-in detected" window and offers to take a photo.	Pop-up after sign-in; photo path in the *Windows sign-ins* tab
Continuous live monitoring across browsers	Every 30 seconds (adjustable) it collects new visits from Chrome, Edge, Brave, Vivaldi, Opera, Opera GX, Chromium and Firefox (all profiles).	*Website history* tab
Advanced threat intelligence	Compares every site with public malware / phishing / botnet lists, scores look-alike and suspicious addresses, checks your live connections against botnet servers, and optionally asks VirusTotal.	Red / amber rows, red banner, *Threat intelligence* tab
Camera permission	Checks the Windows camera privacy switches and opens the right Windows page for you.	*Settings* tab and Dashboard

What LOG USE never does: it never hides itself, never records passwords or keystrokes, never reads the content of web pages, and never sends your data anywhere. Everything is stored on your PC in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\LOG USE`.

> **Use it responsibly.** Install it only on a PC you own or administer. If other people use the PC, tell them it records sign-ins and browsing and may take a photo at sign-in. Using it to watch another person without their knowledge may be illegal.

2. Installing

No command window appears at any point, and no Python or library needs to be installed — everything is already inside the program.

2.0 Two ways to install

The project builds two installers into the `installer_output` folder. Use whichever you were given.

	A. Windows App Installer (MSIX)	**B. Classic setup wizard**
Files	`LOG-USE.msix`, `LOG-USE.cer`, `Install_LOG_USE.vbs`, `trust_and_install.ps1` (keep them together)	`LOG-USE-Setup.exe`
Look	Standard Windows "Install LOG USE?" window with progress bar and *Launch when ready*	Setup wizard with the LOG USE logo
Start at sign-in	Built in (Windows startup task)	Optional task in the wizard
Sign-in auditing	LOG USE asks on first start (one Windows confirmation)	Done during setup (task ticked)
Uninstall	*Settings → Apps → Installed apps*	*Settings → Apps → Installed apps*

A. Windows App Installer (recommended). Double-click **`Install_LOG_USE.vbs`**. No command window appears. Windows asks once, with an administrator confirmation, to trust the LOG USE publisher certificate (`LOG-USE.cer`), then shows the App Installer window; click **Install**.

- Start at sign-in is built in. To switch it on or off use Windows *Settings → Apps → Startup → LOG USE*. The Dashboard switch opens that page for you.
- The first time LOG USE opens it asks permission (one Windows confirmation) to turn on sign-in auditing and to read the Security log. **Sign out of Windows and in again once afterwards.**
- Camera: Windows shows its own camera permission prompt the first time the camera is used.
- The package is self-signed, so Windows shows an *unknown publisher* until the certificate is trusted by the helper above. For a green "Trusted App" label on every PC without this step, sign the package with a purchased code-signing certificate (or Azure Trusted Signing) — see section 9.
- Needs Windows 10 version 1809 or later.
- If you double-click `LOG-USE.msix` directly instead of the helper, Windows may say the app is not trusted. Use `Install_LOG_USE.vbs`.

B. Classic setup wizard — `LOG-USE-Setup.exe` (steps in 2.2). It does the sign-in auditing and *Event Log Readers* setup during installation.

2.1 Requirements

- Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
- An administrator account (needed **once**: during setup, or for the one-time sign-in permission in the App Installer version)
- A webcam (optional, only for the sign-in photo)
- Internet (optional, only for threat-list updates)

You do **not** need to install Python or any library. Everything — Python, OpenCV (camera), requests (web), psutil (system) — is already packed inside the installer.

2.2 Step by step (classic setup wizard)

1. Double-click **LOG-USE-Setup.exe**.
2. If Windows SmartScreen says *"Windows protected your PC"*, click **More info → Run anyway**. (This appears for any new program that is not code-signed.)
3. Click **Yes** on the administrator prompt.
4. Read the disclosure page and click **Next**.
5. Choose the install folder (the default is fine).
6. On the *Select Additional Tasks* page, keep these ticked:
   - **Create a desktop shortcut** (optional)
   - **Start LOG USE every time I sign in to Windows** — needed for the sign-in camera prompt
   - **Turn on Windows sign-in auditing and allow me to read the Security log** — needed for exact authentication events
7. Click **Install**. Setup copies the program and all libraries, switches on Windows *Logon / Logoff* auditing, adds you to the *Event Log Readers* group and creates the start-at-sign-in entry.
8. On the last page, tick **Open Windows camera privacy settings** and **Open the User Guide**, then click **Finish**.
9. **Sign out of Windows and sign in again once.** Windows only applies the *Event Log Readers* membership at the next sign-in.

2.3 Allow the camera (one-time, done by you)

Windows does not let any installer switch the camera permission on for you — only you can. Open **Settings → Privacy & security → Camera** and turn ON:

1. **Camera access**
2. **Let apps access your camera**
3. **Let desktop apps access your camera**

In LOG USE you can check this any time: *Settings tab → CHECK CAMERA PERMISSION*.

3. First start

1. Open **LOG USE** from the desktop or Start menu.
2. Click **Create account**, enter your e-mail and a password of at least 10 characters, then **Sign in**. This account only protects the LOG USE window on this PC.
3. Press **READ SIGN-IN EVENTS NOW** (Dashboard). The first read loads the last 7 days of Windows sign-in events.
4. Press **UPDATE THREAT FEEDS** (needs internet) to download the threat lists.
5. Press **IMPORT BROWSER HISTORY NOW**. The first import loads the last 30 days; afterwards new visits arrive automatically.

4. The tabs

4.1 Dashboard

- Five counters: website records, Windows sign-in events, failed sign-ins, threat alerts, activity events.
- Three switches:
  - **Continuous live monitoring** — pauses / resumes the browser and connection checks.
  - **Read Windows sign-in events** — switches the Security-log reader on or off.
  - **Start LOG USE every time I sign in** — adds / removes the start-at-sign-in entry. (App Installer version: opens Windows *Settings → Apps → Startup*, where you switch *LOG USE* on or off.)
- The status line at the bottom shows camera permission, how many threat indicators are loaded and any problem (for example "Access denied" to the Security log).
- The top-right shows **Live monitoring: ACTIVE / PAUSED** and the time of the last check.

4.2 Windows sign-ins

One row per event, newest first.

Colour	Meaning
Green	Successful sign-in or unlock
Red	**Failed** sign-in — the *Failure reason* column explains why (wrong password, unknown user, locked-out account …)
Plain	Sign-out, lock, unlock

Rows that have a photo show its file name; **double-click** to open it. *EXPORT CSV* saves the list to `%LOCALAPPDATA%\LOG USE\reports`.

Sign-in types: *Interactive* = at the keyboard · *Unlock* = unlocking a locked PC · *Remote Desktop* = someone connected remotely · *Cached* = offline domain sign-in · *Network* = access to a shared folder from another PC.

> **Look for:** several red rows in a row, red rows from a *Source IP*, any *Remote Desktop* row you did not make, or a sign-in at a time you were away.

4.3 Website history

Every visit with time, browser, threat level, domain, IP (after a lookup) and URL.

- **Red row = MALICIOUS** — the address is on a malware / phishing / botnet list.
- **Amber row = SUSPICIOUS** — it looks like a trick (see 4.4) but is not on a list.
- Tick **Show only threats** to filter.
- **RESOLVE IPs** performs a DNS lookup *now*; it is the current address, not necessarily the one used at the time of the visit.

4.4 Threat intelligence

Feeds used (public, free; each can be unavailable on a given day):

Feed	Contains
URLhaus	Live malware-distribution URLs
OpenPhish	Phishing URLs
Phishing Army	Phishing domains
Feodo Tracker	Botnet command-and-control IP addresses

Feeds update automatically every 12 hours while LOG USE is open (change in *Settings*). After each update your whole history is re-checked, so an old visit can turn red later.

Suspicious-address checks (each adds points; 3 or more = *suspicious*): raw IP instead of a name · `@` hidden in the address · look-alike characters (punycode) · typo-squatting such as `paypa1.com` · a famous brand name on an unrelated domain · high-abuse endings (.zip, .top, .tk …) · URL shorteners · "login / verify / secure" words in the domain · log-in pages without HTTPS · extremely long or heavily encoded URLs.

Live connection check — every minute, the programs on your PC that are talking to a known botnet server are listed with the program name.

VirusTotal (optional): get a free key at virustotal.com, paste it in *Settings*, then type a domain in the *Threat intelligence* tab and press **CHECK**.

> **Important:** "No threat found" never means "safe". It only means the address is not on the loaded lists and did not look tricky.

When something is found you get a red banner, a warning window (malicious only) and a row in the alert list. The same address is not announced again for 24 hours.

4.5 Website security

Type any address and press **CHECK WEBSITE SECURITY**. You get: HTTPS, certificate validation result, the main security headers (HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options …) and the threat-list result. It is a basic configuration check, not a vulnerability scan.

4.6 Activity

LOG USE's own log: starts, closes, sign-ins to LOG USE, settings changes, photos, feed updates, errors.

4.7 Settings

- **Camera at Windows sign-in** — choose one:
  - **Ask me each time (recommended)** — a window asks *TAKE PHOTO* or *SKIP*.
  - **Automatic photo after a visible countdown** — a window counts down (default 10 s); press **CANCEL** to stop it. The camera light is on while the photo is taken.
  - **Never** — only the sign-in summary is shown.
- **Countdown seconds**, **Browser check interval** (minimum 5 s), **Feed update interval**.
- **VirusTotal API key** — stored encrypted for your Windows user.
- **E-mail (SMTP)** — only needed for "Forgot password?". For Gmail: server `smtp.gmail.com`, port `587`, your address, and an **App password** (Google Account → Security → 2-Step Verification → App passwords). The password is stored encrypted for your Windows user.
- **CHECK CAMERA PERMISSION** and **OPEN WINDOWS CAMERA SETTINGS**. (App Installer version: the "desktop apps" switch does not apply; only *Camera access* is checked.)

Press **SAVE SETTINGS** after changes.

5. The sign-in camera prompt — how it works

1. You sign in to Windows (password, PIN, Hello …).
2. A few seconds later LOG USE starts (minimised in the taskbar) and reads the Security log. While it runs it checks for new sign-in events every 30 seconds.
3. A window **"Windows sign-in detected"** appears with the user, exact time, sign-in type and Windows event number. If anyone **failed** to sign in since LOG USE last ran, a red warning lists how many and when.
4. Depending on your Settings: you click **TAKE PHOTO**, or the countdown runs, or nothing is asked.
5. The photo is saved with a time stamp in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\LOG USE\photos` and linked to that sign-in row.

Honest limits

- A program cannot run on the Windows *lock screen*, so the photo is taken **right after a successful sign-in**, not while someone is typing a wrong password. Failed attempts are reported in the warning and in the list, with time, user and source.
- The camera permission switch (section 2.3) must be turned on by you.
- Photos are only of whoever is in front of the camera when the prompt appears.

6. Closing, pausing, uninstalling

- Closing the window asks: **Yes** = stop monitoring · **No** = minimise and keep monitoring · **Cancel** = stay open. Monitoring only runs while LOG USE is running — there is no hidden background service.
- **Pause** live monitoring any time on the Dashboard.
- **Uninstall:** *Settings → Apps → Installed apps → LOG USE → Uninstall*. This works for both installers and removes the program and the start-at-sign-in entry. With the classic setup your data stays in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\LOG USE` — delete that folder to erase it. With the App Installer version Windows keeps the data in the app's own package folder (see section 8) and normally removes it with the app; export any CSV reports first. (The Windows auditing settings and group membership are left as they were, because other tools may use them.)

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"Access to the Windows Security log was denied"	Sign out of Windows and in again (the group change applies at sign-in). Still failing? Right-click **LOG USE → Run as administrator**.
No sign-in events appear	Press *READ SIGN-IN EVENTS NOW*. Make sure the *winaudit* task was ticked during setup, or run `auditpol /set /subcategory:"Logon" /success:enable /failure:enable` in an administrator Command Prompt.
Camera error / no photo	Section 2.3. Close other programs using the camera (Teams, Zoom). Check *Settings → CHECK CAMERA PERMISSION*.
Browser shows "Could not read"	Close that browser for a few seconds and press *IMPORT BROWSER HISTORY NOW*.
"Feed FAILED"	The site was unreachable (offline, firewall). Others still work; retry later.
Antivirus warns about the installer	New, unsigned programs are often flagged by mistake. Check the file came from your own build, then allow it. A code-signing certificate removes this.
"LOG USE is already running"	Only one copy may run. Look for it in the taskbar.
Windows says the publisher is unknown or the app is not	Install with **`Install_LOG_USE.vbs`**, not by double-clicking the `.msix`. Keep `LOG-USE.cer`, `LOG-USE.msix` and

Problem	Fix
trusted (App Installer)	`trust_and_install.ps1` in the same folder and accept the one administrator confirmation.
Nothing happens when `Install_LOG_USE.vbs` is run	Extract the whole zip first (do not run it from inside the zip). Check that `LOG-USE.msix` and `LOG-USE.cer` are next to it.
Sign-in events missing after the App Installer install	Accept the first-start permission prompt, then sign out and in again. If you declined it, run `auditpol /set /subcategory:"Logon" /success:enable /failure:enable` in an administrator Command Prompt and add your user to the *Event Log Readers* group.
LOG USE does not start at sign-in (App Installer)	*Settings* → *Apps* → *Startup* → switch **LOG USE** on.
"Forgot password" does not send mail	Fill in the e-mail section in *Settings* first (needs an app password).

8. Where your data is

`%LOCALAPPDATA%\LOG USE\` (classic setup; type this in File Explorer's address bar)

Item	File
All records	`log_use.db` (SQLite)
CSV exports	`reports\`
Photos	`photos\`

App Installer version: Windows redirects the program's `%LOCALAPPDATA%` writes into the package folder, normally `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Packages\LOGUSE.PersonalSecurityMonitor_<id>\LocalCache\Local\LOG USE\`. The file names inside are the same. Sign-in photos and CSV exports can also be opened from inside LOG USE (double-click the row; *EXPORT CSV* shows the saved path).

9. For the person building the installer

You do **not** need this section if you were given `LOG-USE-Setup.exe` or the App Installer files.

What is in the project zip

File / folder	Purpose
`main.py`, `core.py`, `winevents.py`, `browsers.py`, `monitor.py`, `threatintel.py`, `camera.py`	The program
`requirements.txt`	Python libraries (requests, OpenCV,

File / folder	Purpose
	psutil, PyInstaller)
`Build_LOG_USE_Setup.vbs`, `build_installer.bat`	One-click build (invisible console)
`installer.iss`, `assets\`	Classic setup wizard (Inno Setup), logo, icons, install notice
`build_msix.ps1`, `msix\`	App Installer package, certificate, `Install_LOG_USE.vbs`
`.github\workflows\build-windows.yml`	Cloud build on GitHub
`docs\`	This guide (`.md`, `.docx`, `.pdf`); the setup wizard installs the PDF and Word copies

Option A — on any Windows 10/11 PC (no black window): extract the project zip and double-click **`Build_LOG_USE_Setup.vbs`**. Everything runs invisibly: Python and **every library** in `requirements.txt` are installed, the program is built with PyInstaller, Inno Setup is installed if missing, `LOG-USE-Setup.exe` is created, and the App Installer package is created (this step installs the Windows SDK through winget if it is missing). A message box announces when the build is finished and opens `installer_output`. If anything fails, details are saved in `build_log.txt`; if only the MSIX step fails, `LOG-USE-Setup.exe` is still ready. Double-clicking `build_installer.bat` does the same; only `build_installer.bat /show` from a command prompt shows the console.

Option B — without a build PC: upload the project folder to a GitHub repository, open *Actions → Build Windows installer → Run workflow*, and download **LOG-USE-Setup** from the run's artifacts. It contains both the setup EXE and the App Installer files.

Output (`installer_output`): `LOG-USE-Setup.exe`, `LOG-USE.msix`, `LOG-USE.cer`, `Install_LOG_USE.vbs`, `trust_and_install.ps1`.

Silent install (for IT, classic setup): `LOG-USE-Setup.exe /VERYSILENT /TASKS="autostart,winaudit,desktopicon"`

Removing the publisher warning: replace the self-signed certificate. Sign `LOG-USE.msix` with your own code-signing certificate; the `Publisher` in `msix\AppxManifest.xml` must equal the certificate subject. Signing `LOG-USE-Setup.exe` with a code-signing certificate also reduces the SmartScreen warning.

Run from source (developers): `py -3.12 -m venv .venv`, activate it, `pip install -r requirements.txt`, then `python main.py`.

10. Quick reference

I want to …	Do this
See who signed in and when	*Windows sign-ins* tab
Know if someone tried to guess	Red rows in *Windows sign-ins* / red banner

I want to …	Do this
my password	
See a photo of who signed in	Set camera mode (Settings), then double-click the row
Check a suspicious link	*Website security* tab, or *Threat intelligence → VirusTotal*
Stop monitoring	Dashboard → untick *Continuous live monitoring*
Remove everything	Uninstall (*Settings → Apps*), then delete `%LOCALAPPDATA%\LOG USE` if it still exists

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